Next Delivery Date Tells You What It Really Means

Last Updated: 2026-10-19

Status: **Awaiting approval** — nothing has been changed yet for this item.

The inbound "next delivery date" is almost never a supplier-confirmed date, and on most cards it is not shown at all. This item proposes making the date honest and visible.

What You See Before

Infor Visual holds four different kinds of date on an open purchase order line, and the board picks the first one it finds in this order:

1. Line promise delivery date.
2. Line promise ship date.
3. Purchase-order header promise delivery date.
4. Purchase-order header promise ship date.
5. Line desired receive date.
6. Purchase-order header desired receive date.
7. Purchase-order order date.

Three problems come with that:

- Almost every line skips steps 1 and 2. Of the 949 open PO lines in MTMFG on 10/19/2026, 947 had
  no line-level promise date, and 388 had no promise date anywhere on the line or header. The board therefore shows a *requested* date, not a confirmed one, but the card text reads `Next material date: PO desired receive 12/11/2026` , which sounds confirmed.
- The card header only has room for one summary. When a part has any associated work order, the header shows the job summary and the next delivery date disappears from the card. You have to open `View incoming details` or print the board to see it.
- If a purchase order had neither a promise date nor a desired receive date, the board would fall back to the order date and present the day the PO was written as if it were the delivery date. No live line hits this today, but it is one data-entry gap away from printing a false date.

What You Would See After

The Incoming Material section always carries a date line:

```
Incoming Material
Received 0   Ordered 13,000   Remaining 13,000
Expected delivery: 12/11/2026 (confirmed by PO promise)
```

and, when the date has already passed with quantity still outstanding:

```
Expected delivery: 10/14/2026 (requested receive date - overdue 5 days)
```

The wording changes from "next material date" to either `confirmed` or `requested` so you can tell a supplier commitment from an internal wish. If no delivery date exists at all, the board says `No delivery date on the PO` instead of quietly showing the order date.

The printed board would also stop listing the same date twice under two different labels.

Why It Matters

Receiving decides what to expedite from this date. A requested date that is three weeks out looks identical to a confirmed promise today, and a missing date hides behind the job summary.

Decision Needed

- Do you want confirmed and requested dates shown as separate, clearly worded lines, or one line that says which kind it is?
- Should the order-date fallback be removed entirely, or kept but labeled `PO order date (no confirmation)`?

See Also

- Implementation note
- 06 — Look Ahead actually filters inbound material